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Ancient Architecture: Buildings That Tell Stories

Ancient buildings—temples, palaces, walls, and towers—stand as reminders of human history. They were built without modern machines, yet many have survived for thousands of years. These structures show how people lived, what they believed, and what they achieved. Studying ancient architecture helps us understand past civilizations and appreciate the skill and creativity of our ancestors. [1]

One famous example is the Great Wall of China, which stretches over 13,000 miles. It was built over many centuries to protect China from northern invasions. Workers carried stones and bricks by hand and used simple tools. The wall follows mountains and valleys, showing how builders adapted to the land. [2]

In Egypt, the pyramids were built as tombs for pharaohs. The largest, the Great Pyramid of Giza, was the tallest human-made structure in the world for nearly 4,000 years. Scientists still debate exactly how the ancient Egyptians moved such huge stones without wheels or cranes. Their methods remain one of history's great mysteries. [3]

Ancient builders used local materials—stone, brick, wood, and mud. They designed structures to fit the climate: thick walls for cold regions, open courtyards for hot ones. Many buildings were decorated with carvings, paintings, or mosaics that told stories or honored gods and kings. [4]

Today, many ancient sites face threats from pollution, tourism, and natural decay. UNESCO and other groups work to protect these places so future generations can see them. Visiting ancient architecture, whether in person or through books and videos, connects us to the past and inspires wonder. [5]

选项

A. Ancient architecture is more than old stones—it is a window into how people thought, worked, and dreamed long before our time. B. Like other great ancient works, it stands as a symbol of human determination and the ability to achieve the seemingly impossible. C. These ancient wonders continue to puzzle and inspire us, reminding us that the past still holds many secrets. D. Through their choices of materials and design, ancient builders left behind a record of their knowledge and culture. E. Protecting and learning from these treasures ensures that the lessons of the past are not lost. F. For example, the Colosseum in Rome could hold up to 80,000 people for gladiator games and public events.

答案键（Answer Key）

[1] A [2] B [3] C [4] D [5] E

深度解析

- **[1] A**：
  - **线索**：空前介绍古建筑类型、无现代机械却千年屹立、反映生活信仰成就、研究古建可理解文明与先人技艺，空后需总结古建的历史窗口意义。A的"more than old stones"与"stand as reminders"呼应，"window into how people thought, worked, and dreamed"与"understand past civilizations"对应。
- **[2] B**：
  - **线索**：空前描述长城规模、建造目的、人工搬运、随地形而建，空后需总结象征意义。B的"Like other great ancient works"与前文长城对应，"symbol of human determination and the ability to achieve the seemingly impossible"与前文工程难度呼应。
- **[3] C**：
  - **线索**：空前介绍金字塔用途、吉萨大金字塔高度纪录、运输方法仍存争议、成为历史之谜，空后需总结神秘与启发。C的"These ancient wonders"指代金字塔等，"continue to puzzle and inspire us"与"great mysteries"呼应，"past still holds many secrets"承接争议。
- **[4] D**：
  - **线索**：空前说古人用本地材料、因地制宜（厚墙御寒、庭院散热）、装饰雕刻壁画马赛克讲述故事与敬神，空后需总结建造者的智慧传承。D的"Through their choices of materials and design"与前文对应，"left behind a record of their knowledge and culture"概括本段内容。
- **[5] E**：
  - **线索**：空前指出古建面临污染旅游自然侵蚀、UNESCO等组织保护、实地或书籍影像参观可联结过去激发赞叹，空后需总结保护与传承价值。E的"Protecting and learning from these treasures"与前文措施对应，"lessons of the past are not lost"是合理收尾。
- **干扰项分析**：
  - **F. For example, the Colosseum in Rome...**：以For example开头，为具体古建案例（罗马斗兽场）。各空均为概括或过渡句；[2]易被误选因涉及著名建筑，但该空需总结长城等工程的象征意义，而非补充另一建筑的具体数据。